PD 04

Programme document

The teaching-week template

PROGRAMME

For students and lecturers · read before the semester

> “Every teaching week in every course book is written to a single standard: not less than 8,000 words of week content, delivered through the same thirteen components so a student always knows where…”

One of four programme documents that frame the 28-volume lecture library: the student handbook, the lecturer's teaching and assessment guide, the figure index and the visual figure gallery.

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The teaching-week template

This volume is one of 28 course books that together cover the whole MSc Marriage and Family Therapy taught programme. Each book is written to carry a 14–16 week semester on its own: every week pairs a core idea with the practice that follows from it, a worked case, and a reflective task, and each book closes with an integration chapter, a glossary and a self-assessment paper with model answers.

The books are designed to be read straight through before the semester begins, revisited week by week, and used again in revision. Cross-references point to the other volumes where a topic is treated in more depth.

How to cite this volume

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A note on the case material

All families, couples and individuals in this book are fictional composites. They are written to teach pattern recognition, not to describe any real person. Nothing here replaces supervised clinical practice, professional registration, legal advice or medical care; legal content is orientation only and must be checked against the law of the relevant jurisdiction.

The lecture library

Twenty-eight self-contained course books carry the taught programme: eight in Semester One, seven in Semester Two, seven in Semester Three including the thesis, and six electives. The volume you are holding is marked in the margin.

Code	Course	Semester	Units
MFT 701	Fundamentals of Marriage and Family Therapy	One	1.71
MFT 702	Theories of Family Therapy	One	1.71
MFT 703	Human Development Across the Lifespan	One	1.71
MFT 704	Ethical and Legal Issues in Therapy	One	1.71
MFT 705	Research Methods in Marriage and Family Therapy	One	1.71
MFT 706	Clinical Practice and Techniques	One	1.71
MFT 707	Assessment and Diagnosis in Family Therapy	One	1.71
MFT 708	Cultural Competence in Therapy	One	1.71
MFT 709	Group Therapy Techniques	Two	1.71
MFT 710	Couples Therapy	Two	1.71
MFT 711	Child and Adolescent Therapy	Two	1.71
MFT 712	Crisis Intervention Strategies	Two	1.71
MFT 713	Substance Abuse and Family Dynamics	Two	1.71
MFT 714	Trauma-Informed Care	Two	1.71
MFT 715	Family Systems Theory	Two	1.71
MFT 716	Communication Skills in Therapy	Three	1.71
MFT 717	Psychopathology in Families	Three	1.71
MFT 718	Intimacy and Relationship Dynamics	Three	1.71
MFT 719	Family Life Cycle and Transitions	Three	1.71
MFT 720	Supervision and Consultation in Therapy	Three	1.71
MFT 721	Research Methodology	Three	1.71
MFT 722	Professional Development and Self-Care	Electives	1.71
MFT 723	Special Populations in Therapy	Electives	1.71
MFT 724	Family Law and Advocacy	Electives	1.71
MFT 725	Integrative Approaches in Therapy	Electives	1.71
MFT 726	Neurobiology of Relationships	Electives	1.71
MFT 727	Play Therapy Techniques	Electives	1.71
MFT 770	Master Thesis	Three	1.71

Contents

Placeholder for table of contents 0

Every teaching week in every course book is written to a single standard: **not less than 8,000 words of week content**, delivered through the same thirteen components so a student always knows where to find what. The checker (`scripts/check_week_lengths.py`) measures each week from its heading to the next `##` heading, and fails the build if any week falls short.

#	Component	Target words	Purpose
1	Week at a glance — the 90-minute lecture plan	250	What happens in the session, minute by minute
2	Lecture notes — six to nine numbered sections	2,800–3,200	The substance: concepts, mechanisms, debates, numbers
3	Worked case study	1,000–1,300	One family, fully formulated, with the reasoning shown
4	Annotated transcript	600–800	What the therapist did, turn by turn, and why
5	Laboratory protocol + marking rubric	600–800	The assessed practice, with criteria and weights
6	Skills drill	250–350	A repeatable exercise for deliberate practice
7	Six common errors	350–450	What trainees actually get wrong, and the fix
8	Culture, faith and context note	350–450	Local application, with the caution attached
9	Evidence note or debate	350–450	What the literature supports, with hedges intact
10	Key terms table	400–500	12–18 terms defined for the examination
11	Self-test — MCQs, short answers, model answers	550–700	Formative assessment with the key
12	Reflective task	180–250	The personal work that makes the week stick
13	Readings	120–200	Two core, four extension, with what to notice

House style for week content

- Headings: `### 7.1`, `### 7.2` … under the week's `##` heading, so the PDF contents nests correctly.
- Callouts are blockquote panels, one per line start: `> CASE —`, `> PRACTICAL —`, `> CAUTION —`, `> DEBATE —`, `> REFLECT —`, `> DRILL —`, `> TASK —`, `> AUDIT —`. Dialogue is written as `> Speaker: …` lines.
- Cases are fictional composites. Names recur across the library so students meet the same families in different courses: the Adeyemi family, Mrs Okonkwo and Ebuka (9), Folake and Dele, Aisha and Sam.
- Every clinical claim that has an evidence base gets a hedge: robust, plausible, popular but unsupported. Students are being trained to read, not to believe.
- Currency: all figures cited as a percentage must be internally consistent within the book; where a figure is illustrative rather than sourced, say so.

- No week may end without a reflective task and a reading list.

Word-count discipline. Prose is not padded. The word count is met by covering the topic properly: the history of the idea, the mechanism, the clinical procedure, the failure modes, the cultural application, the evidence, the assessment. A week that reaches 8,000 words by repetition is a failed week; a week that reaches 8,000 words because the topic needed it is the standard.